

CYBER CRIME AWARENESS CASE STUDY

Phishing is a sophisticated form of social engineering where attackers masquerade as trusted entities—such as banks, universities, or popular tech services—to trick victims into revealing sensitive information like login credentials, credit card numbers, or social security details. This crime typically begins with a deceptive email or text message that creates a false sense of urgency, often claiming that the victim's account has been compromised or will be suspended if they do not "verify" their identity immediately. When the user clicks the provided link, they are redirected to a spoofed website that looks identical to a legitimate login portal, but any data entered is actually sent directly to the attacker's server. While anyone can be a target, students and office workers are frequently singled out through "spear phishing" campaigns tailored to their specific school or workplace. The consequences of such an attack are often devastating, ranging from immediate financial theft and the loss of personal files to long-term identity fraud and large-scale corporate data breaches. By exploiting human psychology rather than just technical vulnerabilities, phishing remains one of the most effective and widespread cyberthreats in the digital age, requiring constant vigilance and the use of multi-factor authentication to combat.